

able to cover, you'll want to take the precaution now rather than later. From what I've researched, companies like Healthy Paws and Pet Plan have the best reviews.

4. SHOP AROUND FOR FOOD

If you've ever bought pet food at a chain retail pet store, you know the cost is much higher than Walmart or other discount stores. Shop around and compare prices on pet food to see exactly where you should buy. You might be surprised to find some of the cheapest prices are actually online!

We used to buy all our Timothy Hay for our rabbit through Amazon's Subscribe and Save program (before they stopped offering the product, that is), and even though it's just a few cents cheaper than Walmart, it's still super convenient to have pet food shipped straight to our door. You can also look up your preferred brand of pet food online to see if the company offers any coupons. Combine that with a sale and rewards app, and you'll always get your pet's food for cheap.

Another idea is to make store-bought items at home for less. Both dog and cat treat recipes are practically everywhere (hello, Pinterest!), and all you need is a cute cookie cutter. Ingredients are easy to find too. Most involve some combination of peanut butter, banana, yogurt, and flax seed.

5. GROOM THEM YOURSELF

Grooming your pet at home will not only eliminate the tangles and excessive pet hair problems, but it will also save you a lot more money in the long run. Invest in a simple clipper set, watch a few YouTube tutorials, and give it a go.

However, if your pet does not appreciate your taming their mane (and lets you know it!), you might be better off letting a professional handle it next time around. You can still save money at the groomer's by skipping the fancy cut. A "field cut" means they cut the hair the same length over the entire body, saving the groomer time, and you, money.